

Ian Cowpar

Principal-scope Product Leader · AI-first SaaS · Platform & Adoption · 0→1 Builder

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SUMMARY

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager · UKG · Lowell, MA · Jun 2024 – Apr 2026

Principal-scope product ownership across AI capability, 0→1 builds, and opinionated data products serving 300 enterprise customers on a \$250M ARR platform.

- Built the AI capability layer and the 0→1 migration product detailed above.
- Influenced cross-functional prioritization across product, engineering, and services without direct authority in executive escalation rooms, synthesizing what 300 customers (\$250M ARR) actually needed against what was committed and translating that into tradeoff decisions across four product lines.
- Designed delivery-health instrumentation refreshing every 15 minutes across two engineering teams, with documented rejection criteria for burndown, velocity, and story-point anti-patterns. Process governance built for signal, not ceremony.
- Brand Champion, UKG North America Regional Lead 2026. Fire Up ERG (women and allies), Business Innovation workstream lead.

Business Analyst · Broadridge Financial Solutions · Andover, MA · Jan 2014 – Jun 2024

Forty-plus enterprise SaaS deployments end-to-end in compliance-grade financial services, where client confidentiality and regulatory consequence shaped every delivery decision.

- Internal subject-matter expert for an omni-channel communication product adopted across the full enterprise client base. Translated complex compliance capabilities into workflows non-technical buyers could operate without support.
- Partnered deeply with engineering on system behavior, data flows, integration dependencies, and technical tradeoffs. Built strong instincts for the difference between a delivery that closes and a product that keeps producing.

Senior Document Development Analyst · Broadridge Financial Solutions · Andover, MA · Jan 2006 – Jan 2014

Product Strategy & Leadership — Principal-scope ownership, two-to-three-year product vision, OKR-to-execution, roadmap and prioritization in ambiguous spaces, cross-functional leadership without direct authority, mentorship of junior PMs, recognized SME, outcomes over output, B2B SaaS

AI as Core Multiplier — AI capability platform building, embedded AI features inside internal products, Claude Code prototyping, twenty custom slash commands and a personal Claude Code productivity OS in active daily use, agentic workflows, responsible and customer-centric AI judgment, AI adoption measurement (extinction over addition; the fallback principle)

Technical Credibility — APIs and system architecture, data flows and integration tradeoffs, deployment-model and platform product thinking, technical-systems fluency with engineering, requirements engineering, SQL

Data & Experimentation — Opinionated analytics products that route a decision rather than display one, composite scoring and risk modeling, success-metric definition, hypothesis-driven development, qualitative-to-structured synthesis

Enterprise SaaS — Compliance-grade regulated delivery, client confidentiality as table stakes, enterprise customer escalation-room presence, multi-org program coordination, executive synthesis

Tooling — Jira, Confluence, GitHub, SQL, Claude Code CLI, Slack MCP, Salesforce Service Cloud (operator)

SKILLS AND FOCUS AREAS

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Management Information Systems and Management

Manning School of Business, UMass Lowell · 1999

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

The Unofficial Leader (Substack) · theunofficialleader.substack.com

Weekly publication on where AI actually earns its place, adoption realism, and what's happening beneath the surface of how teams work. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework. Active LinkedIn audience engagement on product strategy, AI adoption, and team dynamics.

WRITING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP